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Imaging Pradip Ingale
Photograph Jiten Gandhi

In Search Of Order

Automobiles of the future will be cool and great and all that jazz, but exactly what technologies will help us drive faster, cleaner and safer?

Robert Sovereign-Smith

All of you reading this magazine do a myriad things with technology that just a decade ago you wouldn't have dreamt of. Technology has changed our lives, and we already know this.

Some things, however, just don't seem to change, at least not for the better!

Take driving your car for instance: sure you have a load of acronyms being advertised for cars today, which basically tell you there's technology going under the hood. But how much of it do you see? Anyone living in a big city in India will tell you that driving a car is becoming quite a painful experience. Traffic jams, pollution, rash drivers, state transport buses, truck drivers who have watched too much Formula 1—the list is never-ending.

The Carma That Ran Over The Dogma

Never before has this funny quote held so much truth in it! Finally, a drastic change seems to be on the horizon, and the concept of the "car" might be overhauled completely sooner than you think!

Cars today are all nice and comfortable. They have computer-controlled fuel-injection, braking, emission and noise reduction, airbags, and a

whole range of other features on offer. However, the problem with cars today is, they're not helping us solve the main problem, which is...

...The Human Problem

Most of us live in overpopulated cities, and traffic jams are an everyday occurrence. We don't need to tell you, of course. Despite the efforts of a few to get us to think about our environment, we drive on, unperturbed. It doesn't matter that the world will run out of oil in less than half a century, or that the ozone layer is getting thinner by the second. We stubbornly refuse to car-pool, and prefer to be stuck in kilometre-long traffic jams of hundreds of cars with just a single driver in each of them... that's just the way we are!

The outcome? Skyrocketing petrol prices, an increase in road transport costs, and, as a result, inflation! We're paying for our callousness with our money *and* our health!

Technologies Of Tomorrow

There are hundreds of upcoming technologies aimed at transport vehicles, but not all of them solve the problems we've detailed above. For example, a killer music system that delivers 5.1 Dolby surround sound, a mobile version of a gaming console for the passengers of a car, or